

Consolidation Discovery: Research Plan

Trial Clerks

Consolidation - September 23, 2022

This research will take place during October 3, 2022 - October 21, 2022	
Related Story	Other Notes
Story 9445 Story: 3820 Story: 5483 Story: 342 Story: 2379 Story: 3571	Consolidation Mural Notes Interview Tracker (restricted access)

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Overview & Purpose

Background information on why this research is needed

The purpose of this research is to engage with USTC Trial Clerks to better understand their experiences with consolidation and to identify opportunities for improvement. USTC stakeholders have prioritized 1 Epic with 4 stories at this time which outline the following objectives:

[EPIC] 3820: “Consolidation” of two or more cases

- Understand user workflows and usability concerns related to consolidation of cases

Story 5483: Consolidated Cases: Display on Dashboard

- Inform the workflow, design, and usability of the consolidation dashboard display

Story 342: Consolidation of cases - System automatically suggests

- Determine whether or not automation would improve the user experience and if so, inform the design and usability of the automation

Story 3571: Court User - QC Edits for Consolidated Cases

- [UX likely not needed] Create consistency by applying edits from one QC across all consolidated cases

Story 9445: UX Design/Research

- Identify pain points for consolidation across all associated users and flows in DAWSON.

Research Goals

Overall aim or vision to outline the purpose of our work

- 1. Understand and document the unique perspectives, needs and experiences of Trial Clerks as related to consolidation**
- 2. Define key moments in the user’s experiences to identify opportunities to improve the consolidation process**
- 3. Create an enhanced user experience across DAWSON’S consolidation process**

Guiding Questions

Overarching “big picture” questions we want to answer through this research

* These questions will not be asked directly to users. Interview guide is outlined below.

- What are users expectations when consolidating cases?
 - What do users need and value?
 - How can we make it easier for users to complete their tasks?
- How does consolidation integrate into a larger workflow?
- How have users done this in the past?
- What challenges and opportunities are there with this process?
 - What areas of the UI impact their experience most?
 - How should we prioritize our improvements?

Research Methods

How we will approach our research to gather the information we need

- 1:1 non-standardized interviews
 - Duration of 30 minutes
 - Scheduled remotely via zoom

Engagement Groups

A list of people we will speak with to learn more about their experiences

In order to gather diverse perspectives from people that utilize DAWSON, we will meet with 5 users with representation from the following category:

Interviewee Participants	
User Type	Approx. # of participants
Trial Clerk Supervisor	1
Trial Clerk	1
Trial Clerk Fill-In (CA/ADAs)	3

Recruitment Email

Email template for scheduling interviews with participants

Subject: DAWSON User Interview

Good Morning _____,

We are User Researchers/Designers with Flexion and are working with USTC on creating a better experience across DAWSON. You were referred to us as a potential participant for an interview, as we are seeking feedback from Trial Clerks on DAWSON. If you are available, we would like to schedule a 45-60 minute discussion with you via Zoom. Please let us know a few times you would be available from Tuesday October 11th - Friday October 14th.

If these days or times don't work, please let us know, we'll do our best to accommodate your schedule. Thank you, we greatly value your feedback and time.

Regards,

Lia and Sui

Interview Guide

Questions we will reference to guide our conversations with users

Slack reminder for team

Post this message in slack 30-60 minutes before an interview.

Hi team! We're about to start another user interview at [ADD TIME] If you'd like to join, please reply in a thread to this post. The first team member to respond gets to join.

A few things to remember:

- You can access the zoom link here: [ADD LINK]
- Only 1 extra team member per interview. We don't want to overwhelm the participant.
- Join on time and stay the whole time. If you can't make the entire interview, we kindly ask you to skip.
- Save questions for the end. Please jot down any questions that come up for you via your personal notes. We will open up the last 5-10 minutes for questions or clarifications.

Intro Script

Hello! My name is _____. I am a User Experience Researcher / Designer working with the U.S. Tax Court and I want to thank you for agreeing to spend time with me today. I have a member / two members of my team in the meeting _____, who is a UX Researcher / Designer and will be taking notes, & _____ who is a _____ and will be observing.

As we mentioned in the email, we want to gather more feedback about how you use Dawson to help inform our designs. We will be asking you a series of questions and at the end, you will get a chance to bring up topics we didn't that are related to consolidation.

Participation in this interview is completely voluntary and optional. You can terminate the session at any time for any reason. Your responses are confidential and when the findings are reported, they will be aggregated and anonymized so that nothing that is said can be tied directly to you.

Please note that we are performing this research to validate ideas and find pain points in Dawson, and we are not testing you as a participant. Feel free to be as open and candid as you would like and don't hold back your opinions. You will not hurt anyone's feelings.

Would it be okay if we record this meeting for note-taking purposes? Your feedback will be kept entirely anonymous and will only be used internally for reporting.

Does that sound good? Any questions before we get started? [Do not record if screen-sharing PII]

Introduction

Notes submitted taken in Google Docs and stored in Google Drive for each interview.

- To start, can you tell us what your current role with the Tax Court is?
 - What are your responsibilities?
 - How long have you had this role?
 - How many judges have you been a trial clerk for?

Consolidating Cases

- How many consolidated cases do you typically have during a trial session?
- How do you handle consolidated cases during trial?

Collaboration with Judges/CAs

- How do you collaborate with the Judge during a trial session?

- (If they trial clerked for more than one judge) How does the process differ with each judge in regards to collaboration with them?
- (If they are not a CA - ask [Sarah & Mason]) Do you communicate with the judge's CA during a trial session?

Session Copy (Trial Clerk view)

Ask Them to Screenshare Session Copy page/If they can't, we'll screenshare Buch's Session Copy

- What are your thoughts on the Session Copy page? How do you know what's consolidated?
 - Probe further depending on their answers.
 - Do you use the sorting functionality on Docket No. and Petitioner Counsel columns? Why or why not?
 - Would it be useful to have the Judge's name on the Session Copy in DAWSON and the printable version? Why or why not?
- How could we improve the Session Copy page?
- Where do you go to print the session information when preparing for trial? (Session Info or Session copy?)
- How important is it for you to see the Judge's notes in their Session Copy during trial?
- (For CA/Trial Clerk hybrid roles) Do you log in as a CA so you can see the Judge's notes or do you log in as a trial clerk?

Note-taking/Minutes

Ask them if they have a minute sheet form they can screenshare?

- How do you take notes? Are they handwritten, typed?
 - Do you use shorthand? Can you give some examples?
 - Have you been given shorthand standards? If not, would standardizing be helpful?
- How do you transcribe your notes into the minute sheets?
 - What challenges, if any, do you encounter during this task?
- (If fields on minute sheet aren't discussed – ask) How useful are the form fields on the minute sheet?
 - How might we improve the minute sheet form?
- After you fill out the minute sheet form, what steps do you take next?
 - Does this process change depending on whether or not the trial is remote?
 - What is the process for consolidated cases?
 - Would having the ability to bulk add make this process easier for you?
 - What is the process with docket (clerks/record)?

Screenshare Session Copy Printable PDF on test

- This is a prototype we are working on, what are your thoughts?
 - Would it be useful to have the Judge's name on the Session Copy in DAWSON and the printable version? Why or why not?
- How do you imagine yourself using this for handwritten notes (once printed out)?
 - (if they don't bring it up - ask) Is there enough space for notes?

Judges Orders

- We've heard that trial clerks would like the ability to sign orders for Judges, can you explain how this would be beneficial?
 - How do you currently handle these Orders? (e.g. daily, after trial session?)

Conclusion

- Is there anything we didn't ask that you'd like to bring up regarding your role and responsibilities, during and outside of trial sessions?
- What's the one thing in Dawson we could improve right now that would make your job easier?

Outro Script

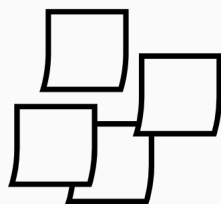
Thanks again for your time and feedback. We truly appreciate it. Know that you are helping to improve Dawson by participating in these sessions. If you think of anything else, please feel free to email us. Have a wonderful day.

Synthesis Process

Overview of how we will synthesize interview data

Our team will utilize affinity mapping to synthesize our interview data and research.

- Data and first-hand accounts from interviews will be transformed into stickies in Mural
- All interview data will be anonymized by a unique participant ID
- Similar stickies will be grouped by theme to uncover insights about the user experience
- Human-centered insights will serve as the foundation for opportunities to improve DAWSON



Review and analyze
interview data



Identify patterns and
discover themes



Articulate insights that
point to opportunities

Outcomes

What will come out of this research

The research gathered from the users will uncover human-centered insights that will serve as the foundation to inform the future design and functionality of DAWSON's consolidation process for online cases.